

29 SWEET JAZZ PIANO LICKS

MAJOR ii-V-I LICKS

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All ii-V-I and ii-V-I-VI licks can be played swing or straight

Chord tone soloing
1 3 5 7 of each chord

C major scale works over all 3 chords in this major ii-V-I

#1 Dm^7 G^7 $Cmaj^7$ #2 Dm^7 G^7 $Cmaj^7$

#3 Dm^7 G^7 $Cmaj^7$

Add a triplet to your lines to vary rhythm

Half-step below approach ($Bb - B$)

G dominant bebop scale (chromatic note = Gb)

Aim to end your lines on 1 3 5 or 7 (C E G B)

#4 Dm^7 G^7 $Cmaj^7$

Half-step below approach ($Bb - B$)

Half-step below approach ($Eb - E$)

The half-step below approach is most effective at the chord changes.
I like to aim for the chord's major 3rd - if it has one:

#5 Dm^7 G^7 $Cmaj^7$

$Bb - B$ $Eb - E$

It's most common to approach the chord tones (1 3 5 7) with the half-step below approach.
However you can even precede all 7 notes in the scale with the half-step below approach (in this case, notes from C major scale):

#6 Dm^7 G^7 $Cmaj^7$

Half-step below approach $F\# - G$ $D\# - E$